Brain is situated in the cranial cavity and covered by three membranes called an outer **duramater**, an inner **piamater** and a middle **arachnoid membrane**. The brain is divided into **forebrain** (prosencephalon), **midbrain** (mesencephalon) and **hindbrain** (rhombencephalon).

Forebrain consists of a pair of olfactory lobes, cerebral hemispheres and diencephalon. The right and left cerebral hemispheres are connected by transverse band of nerve tissue called **corpus callosum**.

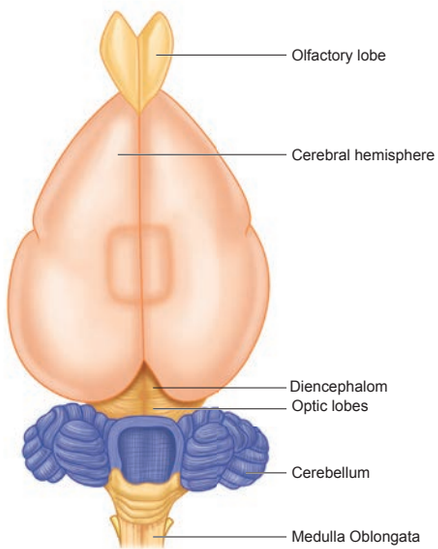


Fig. 13.10 Brain of Rabbit (Dorsal view)

The midbrain includes the optic lobes. The hindbrain consists of the cerebellum, pons varolii and medulla oblongata. You will study about the details of mammalian brain in the chapter on nervous system.

13.2.8 Urinogenital System

It comprises the urinary or excretory system and the genital or reproductive system. Therefore, they are usually described as urinogenital system in vertebrates.

Excretory system

Each kidney is made of several nephrons. It separates the nitrogenous wastes from blood and excretes it in the form of urea. Kidneys are dark red, bean shaped organs situated in the abdominal cavity. From each kidney arises the **ureters** which open posteriorly into the **urinary bladder** and leads into a thick walled muscular duct called **urethra**.

Reproductive System

Sexual dimorphism is exhibited in rabbits. The male and female sexes are separate and are morphologically different.

Male Reproductive system

The male reproductive system of rabbit consists of a pair of testes which are ovoid in shape. Testes are enclosed by scrotal sacs in the abdominal cavity. Each testis consists of numerous fine tubules called **seminiferous tubules**. This network of tubules lead into a coiled tubule called **epididymis,** which lead into the sperm duct called **vas deferens**. The vas deferens join in the urethra just below the urinary bladder. The urethra runs backward and passes into the penis.

There are three accessory glands namely prostate gland, cowper's gland and perineal gland. Their secretions are involved in reproduction.

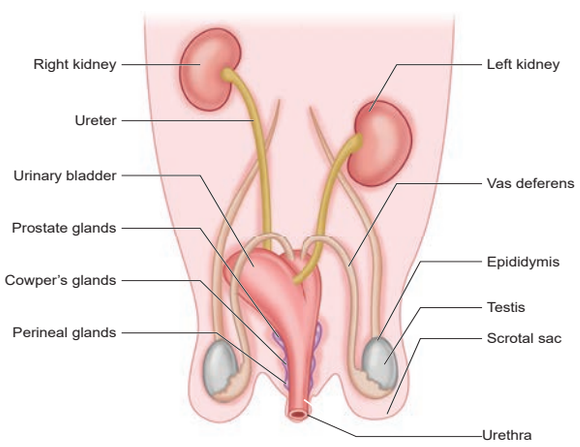


Fig. 13.11 Male reproductive system of Rabbit

Female reproductive system

The female reproductive system of rabbit consists of a pair of ovaries which are small

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